

Gradiate and/or Nengovhela Application Assistance Business Plan

Executive Summary

Gradiate and/or Nengovhela Application Assistance is a transformative web-based platform designed to democratize access to higher education and career opportunities. By intelligently matching students with bursaries and graduates with employment or academic advancement programs, Gradiate and/or Nengovhela Application Assistance serves as a personalized success compass for young people. The platform aims to simplify the journey from school to university and the workforce, removing barriers to opportunity through data-driven, student-centered solutions.

Founders: Nicoroy Zwane & Nengovhela Thandululo

Ownership Structure: 50/50 Partnership

Business Description

Gradiate and/or Nengovhela Application Assistance bridges the gap between students and the opportunities they deserve. Whether it's discovering a bursary, finding a degree program, or transitioning to graduate employment, Gradiate and/or Nengovhela Application Assistance equips users with tailored information based on their academic background, interests, and goals.

Vision

To become the leading digital platform that empowers every learner with the clarity, confidence, and connections needed to succeed.

Mission

To remove barriers to education and employment by intelligently streamlining access to funding and advancement opportunities.

Objectives

1. Empower students with clarity on qualifying opportunities.
2. Simplify access to bursaries, university courses, and graduate programs.
3. Support lifelong learning through continuous discovery.
4. Build trust with ethical and secure data practices.

Product & Services

Gradiate and/or Nengovhela Application Assistance offers the following core features:

Core Features

- **Intelligent Matching System:** Uses academic data and interests to match students to bursaries and graduates to programs.
- **User Dashboard:** A personalized space to manage saved opportunities and track applications.
- **Admin Panel:** Enables organizations to upload and manage listings.
- **AI Chatbot (Upcoming):** Provides real-time support, FAQs, and application help.

Market Analysis

Target Market

- High school students (Grades 11-12)
- University graduates seeking employment or postgraduate opportunities
- Educational institutions and bursary funders.

Market Need

Students and graduates often miss opportunities due to a lack of awareness or guidance. Gradiate and/or Nengovhela Application Assistance solves this problem by offering a centralized platform with personalized, data-driven support.

Competitor Landscape

While there are bursary databases and career platforms, none offer a full-stack, personalized matching experience with integrated academic filters, dashboards, and AI support.

Marketing & Promotion

Strategy

- Promote via LinkedIn, TikTok, Instagram, and high school career fairs.
- Partner with NGOs, schools, universities, and bursary providers.
- Email marketing to early users.

Timeline

- **Pre-launch Buzz:** 1-2 months before MVP release
- **Launch Campaign:** Leverage student influencers and partners
- **Post-launch:** Regular updates, student success stories, and blog content

Operations Plan

Development Stages

- **Phase 1 (MVP):** Matching system, dashboard, and bursary listings
- **Phase 2:** Admin panel and authentication
- **Phase 3:** AI chatbot, analytics, and full React integration

Tech Stack

- **Frontend:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript (React in progress)
- **Backend:** Node.js with Express / Python Flask/Django (TBD)
- **Database:** MongoDB / PostgreSQL / Firebase
- **Auth:** JWT-based login
- **Deployment:** Vercel (Frontend), Render/Heroku (Backend)

Revenue Model

- Freemium for students and graduates with opportunity to change to Premium.
- Premium partnerships with universities and bursary providers
- Advertising opportunities
- Analytics services for institutional partners

Management Team

- **Nicoroy L. Zwane:** Co-Founder, Frontend, Backend, Operations & Strategy
- **Nengovhela Thandululo:** Co-Founder, Frontend, Backend & Operations

Financial Plan (Basic Outline)

- **Initial Costs:** Hosting, domain, platform development
- **Funding Sources:** Bootstrapping, later seed funding or grants

- **Break-even Goal:** Within 2 years post-launch

Risk & Mitigation

Risk	Mitigation Strategy
Data privacy issues	Comply with POPIA; strong data policies
Low user traction	Strong community marketing and partnerships
Tech delays	Agile sprints and realistic deadlines

Appendix

- GitHub: <https://github.com/n-zwane/graduate-platform>
Or : <https://github.com/22001502/my-vite-app>
- Contact: Nicoroy L. Zwane: nicoroyzwane@gmail.com
Nengovela Thandululo: thandululo99@gmail.com

"The world needs your creativity, and the future will be written by those bold enough to reimagine it."
— H.E. Honourable Samantha Graham-Maré, South Africa's Deputy Minister of Electricity & Energy